

**PRE-SOLICITATION NON-COMPETITIVE –
Notice of Intent to Sole Source**

1. **SOLICITATION NUMBER:** 75N98026Q00213
2. **TITLE:** Service Contract for Hamilton STAR V Liquid Handler
3. **RESPONSE DATE:** April 27, 2026, at 9:00 am EDT.
4. **PRIMARY POINT OF CONTACT:**

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I. INTRODUCTION:

THIS IS A PRE-SOLICITATION NON-COMPETITIVE (NOTICE OF INTENT) SYNOPSIS TO AWARD A CONTRACT WITHOUT PROVIDING FOR FULL OR OPEN COMPETITION (INCLUDING BRAND-NAME).

The National Heart, Lung, and Blood Institute (NHLBI), Division of Intramural Research (DIR), Biospecimen Core laboratory supports centralized biospecimen procurement, processing, storage, and distribution for research purposes. To maintain these operations, the laboratory utilizes a Hamilton STAR V liquid handler, an automated system that streamlines biospecimen processing workflows.

This requirement is for a service contract to provide preventive maintenance, repairs, technical support, and software/firmware updates to ensure continued, reliable operation of the Hamilton STAR V system. This instrument is critical to supporting DIR investigators and enabling efficient, high-quality biospecimen processing.

**II. NORTH AMERICAN INDUSTRY CLASSIFICATION SYSTEM (NAICS)
CODE and SET ASIDE STATUS**

NAICS Code: 811210 – Electronic and Precision Equipment Repair and Maintenance, with a size standard of \$34 million.

This acquisition is **NOT set aside for small business**.

III. REGULATORY AUTHORITY

The resultant contract will include all applicable provisions and clauses in effect through the Federal Acquisition Circular (FAC) 2024-07 dated 08-29-2024.

This acquisition is conducted under the procedures as prescribed in FAR Part 12—Acquisition of Commercial Products and Commercial Services and FAR Part 13—Simplified Acquisition Procedures.

IV. STATUTORY AUTHORITY

This acquisition is for a commercial item or service and is conducted under the authority of the FAR Subpart 13.5—Simplified Procedures for Certain Commercial Items and the statutory authority of [specify the applicable authority: (1) FAR 6.302-1—Only one responsible source and no other supplies or services will satisfy agency requirements 41 U.S.C. 3304 (a)(1).

V. DESCRIPTION OF REQUIREMENT:

Purpose and Objectives:

The NHLBI Biospecimen Core laboratory requires a service contract to maintain the operational reliability and performance of the Hamilton STAR V liquid handler following expiration of the manufacturer's warranty.

Purchase Description:

The contractor shall provide a comprehensive service agreement for the Hamilton STAR V liquid handler, including all necessary labor, parts, and travel to perform maintenance and repairs.

Salient Characteristics:

The required service contract must include, at a minimum:

- Preventive maintenance services, including calibration and functional verification
- Coverage of parts, labor, and travel for repairs due to normal use
- Technical support (phone/email) with a response time within four (4) business hours
- Priority on-site service for instrument downtime
- Firmware and software updates
- Maintenance of all existing system functionalities and configurations
- Service performed by manufacturer-trained and authorized personnel

Quantity:

One (1) service contract for the Hamilton STAR V liquid handler

Period of Performance:

May 2, 2026 – May 1, 2027

Place of Performance:

NHLBI Biospecimen Core Laboratory
NIH Clinical Research Center / Building 10
10 Center Drive, Room 8N113
Bethesda, MD 20892

VI. CONTRACTING WITHOUT PROVIDING FOR FULL OR OPEN COMPETITION (INCLUDING BRAND-NAME) DETERMINATION

The determination by the Government to award a contract without providing for full and open competition is based on the results of market research.

Hamilton Company is the only vendor authorized to provide manufacturer-certified service, proprietary parts, and software/firmware updates for the Hamilton STAR V liquid handler system. The equipment is proprietary, and only the original manufacturer can ensure proper maintenance, calibration, and system functionality.

Use of non-authorized service providers would void warranty protections, risk improper servicing, and jeopardize the reliability of biospecimen processing operations critical to NHLBI research.

Market research was conducted through review of manufacturer documentation and publicly available sources, confirming that no third-party vendors are authorized to provide comprehensive service support for this system. Therefore, Hamilton Company is the only responsible source capable of meeting the Government's requirement.

The intended source is:

Hamilton Company

4970 Energy Way

Reno, NV 89502

United States

VII. CLOSING STATEMENT

THIS SYNOPSIS IS NOT A REQUEST FOR COMPETITIVE PROPOSALS. However, interested parties may identify their interest and capability to respond to this requirement.

A determination by the Government not to compete this proposed contract based upon responses to this notice is solely within the discretion of the Government. All responsible sources may submit a capability statement, proposal, or quotation which shall be considered by the agency.

Responses shall contain sufficient information to establish the interested party's capability to meet the requirement and include pricing, delivery terms, and business size status. All offerors must have an active registration in the System for Award Management (SAM) at www.sam.gov.

All responses must be received by the closing date and time of this announcement and must reference solicitation number **75N98026Q00213**. Responses must be submitted electronically to Nicholas Capobianco, Contract Specialist at nicholas.capobianco@nih.gov.